2. To cooperate with UNRWA in providing food and services to refugees in the Gaza Strip.
3. To allow the resumption of fishing in the Gaza Strip.
4. To allow free passage between towns and villages in the Gaza Strip.
5. To provide Gaza residents with essential foodstuffs at reduced prices from government warehouses.
6. To establish arrangements that will enable the agricultural areas of the Gaza Strip to market their produce and export their surplus of oranges and dates.
7. To renew the operation of banks and other financial institutions in the Gaza Strip.
8. To improve the supply of water, electricity and services in the Gaza Strip.

In response to Minister Zalman Aran's question, "What is the point of announcing all this after the UN has decided that we have to withdraw from the Gaza Strip?" Ben-Gurion replied, "In my opinion, there is tremendous value in us announcing this to the world. It does not necessarily mean that the Asian countries will say that the Gaza Strip should remain in our hands. *But it has value, if over the course of time we have thoughts about settling the refugee problem, either partially or entirely!"*

On December 23, 1956, a marathon government meeting was held while IDF forces retreated to El-Arish. According to the original plan, the IDF was supposed to complete the retreat by January 1, 1957. For various reasons, the deadline was postponed. It can be gleaned that the Israeli government had an interest in postponing in order to gain time for further discussion and the formulation of a policy for the postwar period. Another reason for the delay was the renewal of Fedayeen operations from Jordan, inspired by the Egyptian attacks. Dayan, as IDF chief of staff, coordinated the postponement of the withdrawal with General Burns, the emissary of UN secretary general Dag Hammarskjöld, who was not considered to be pro-Israeli in Israel and who persisted in exerting pressure on the Israelis.

Ben-Gurion steered the government wisely and with a vision that sometimes bordered on prophecy, certainly with a rare political astuteness, while allowing space for all his coalition partners to express themselves.